The Cryptoeconomy as a Concentrated Growth Culture

May 2026

Darcy W.E. Allen[1] and Aaron M. Lane[2]

Abstract: This chapter argues that crypto is not merely a technological or financial innovation, but the most concentrated culture of institutional improvement since the Enlightenment. Drawing on Nobel Laureate Joel Mokyr's body of work, we frame the cryptoeconomy as a community that legitimises experimentation, rewards useful knowledge, and sustains belief in progress. Rather than treating growth as the product of incentives or formal institutions alone, Mokyr emphasised the cultural norms and intellectual networks that protect novelty and enable cumulative improvement. The cryptoeconomy's open knowledge communities, composable institutional toolkits, and embedded incentive structures are a public global laboratory for institutional evolution. This chapter argues that Mokyr's cultural framework is a useful lens for understanding crypto as a sustained experiment in building new institutions rather than reforming old ones.

Keywords: Cryptoeconomy; Culture of growth; Institutional innovation; Useful knowledge; Crypto culture; Joel Mokyr

Consistent themes in the elite culture all point in the same direction: a culture of practical improvement, a belief in social progress, and the recognition that useful knowledge was the key to their realization.

— Joel Mokyr, *A Culture of Growth* (p. 267)

1. Crypto as concentrated growth culture

The most consequential piece of monetary architecture in a generation was published pseudonymously, without institutional backing, to a mailing list of cryptographers. It was not commissioned by a central bank, enabled by a legal framework, or debated in a parliamentary committee. That is not how financial infrastructure is supposed to get built. And yet what followed was not merely Bitcoin, but years of radical experimentation from novel forms of

[1] RMIT University, darcywilliamallen@gmail.com
[2] RMIT University, aaron.lane@rmit.edu.au

property rights and identity systems that scan your eyeballs.[3] That institutional change happened this way is the first clue that the cryptoeconomy is not primarily a technological phenomenon but a *cultural* one. And this is precisely the growth culture that Nobel Laureate Joel Mokyr spent his career examining.

When people start investing or building in the cryptoeconomy they famously enter down a *rabbit hole*. One of the most striking parts of that journey is not just the technical complexity but the cultural phenomenon they encounter. There is a strong orientation toward openness and permissionlessness (Nabben & Zargham, 2022), memes that encode optimism and commitment to building, and peculiar ways that participants greet each other (GM). Participation in the cryptoeconomy signals adherence to a belief that institutions are not fixed by history or politics, but they are designable systems that we can build ourselves (Nabben, 2023b).

What distinguishes crypto from conventional technological movements is how builders see themselves in relation to the world. Participants in the cryptoeconomy did not begin by petitioning central banks for monetary policy reforms or lobbying for marginal improvements in financial intermediation. Indeed, many participants were countercultural cypherpunks and utopians (Brunton, 2019; Nabben, 2023a). The technical architecture of blockchains encode various political visions and values (De Filippi & Loveluck, 2016) – they are fundamentally institutional technologies rather than purely technical ones (C. Berg et al., 2019). What began with Bitcoin as an alternative monetary system led to the construction of decentralised exchanges, automated market makers, lending protocols, stablecoins, and programmable treasuries. These are the result of a belief that better institutions can be built, and that users can be invited to migrate voluntarily to them.

To use Albert Hirschman's (1970) framework, crypto actors repeatedly chose exit over voice (Allen, 2019; A. Berg & Berg, 2017). They actively construct and layer alternative institutional arrangements rather than seeking marginal reforms within existing ones (MacDonald, 2019). Hirschman observed that voice becomes dominant primarily when opportunities for exit decline. The cryptoeconomy systematically lowers the costs of exit through permissionless forking and composability. Dissatisfaction with existing systems is channelled into engineering effort rather than political effort, treating institutions as open to deliberate redesign rather than as given natural features of coordination. The result is a culture in which institutions themselves become the domain of innovation — the challenge is not how to persuade existing authorities to modify rules, but how to construct new ones that coordinate human and machine behaviour in decentralised environments without relying on traditional hierarchies.

[3] We are of course referring to Worldcoin, a project that involves an identity verification process using the biometric data of your eyeballs.

Joel Mokyr, recipient of the 2025 Nobel Prize in economics, spent decades studying the origins of modern economic growth. Markets, property rights, and capital accumulation matter, but they are not sufficient for sustained growth. Mokyr points to the beliefs, values, and norms — the *culture* — that determine whether societies protect innovation or suppress it (Mokyr, 2005, 2016). Mokyr argues that growth accelerates when societies develop norms that admire novelty, tolerate heterodox ideas, reward experimentation, and resist institutional vetoes against innovation. Such cultural configurations are, however, historically rare and fragile, and the protection of novelty is cultural before it is legal or political.

In this chapter we argue that the cryptoeconomy represents a contemporary, concentrated instance of such a growth culture. While crypto is seemingly odd and alienating, it is a culture focused on transforming the institutional environment itself. Where the Enlightenment Europe that Mokyr and others have studied developed cultural norms that enabled cumulative technological progress, crypto communities have developed cultural norms that enable cumulative institutional progress. We proceed as follows. Section 2 situates Mokyr's contribution within broader debates about the origins of economic growth and explains why cultural explanations matter alongside institutional and technological ones. Section 3 examines crypto's knowledge communities and their potential fragility. Section 4 examines how cultural entrepreneurs and memes propagate and sustain the growth culture across distributed networks. Section 5 examines how crypto embeds incentives for a growth culture through the creation of digital property rights in tokens. Section 6 concludes.

2 Mokyr and the cultural foundations of growth

The origins of modern economic growth are debated. Why did some societies experience accelerating development whilst others stagnated? Why did the Industrial Revolution occur in Northwestern Europe rather than China or the Islamic world? What preconditions enabled sustained technological progress? Different schools of economic thought have offered competing explanations, each emphasising different mechanisms. Neoclassical growth theory, for instance, emphasised capital accumulation and technological change as the engines of development. Robert Solow's foundational model demonstrated that long-run growth depends on technological progress, though the model treated that progress as exogenous, something that happens outside the model rather than something the model explains. Modern endogenous growth theory further stresses the role of innovation.

The new institutional economics, pioneered by Douglass North (1990), shifted attention to the rules governing economic activity. Growth, in this view, depends on institutions that reduce transaction costs and enable productive exchange. Those institutions include secure property rights, credible commitment mechanisms, and effective legal systems – institutions that lower the costs of transacting with strangers. Daron Acemoglu and James Robinson (2013) extended this institutional emphasis by distinguishing between inclusive institutions

— which distribute power broadly and enable creative destruction — and extractive institutions — which concentrate power and block innovations that threaten existing distributions of wealth. Deirdre McCloskey (2011) argued that the decisive shift occurred in attitudes toward commerce and innovation – when merchants and innovators gained social respect rather than contempt, and bourgeois virtues of enterprise acquired genuine moral legitimacy, entrepreneurial energy flourished. Joel Mokyr, the subject of this chapter, argues that institutions and capital matter, but sustained growth requires a *culture* that legitimises improvement and protects the pursuit and diffusion of useful knowledge. His framework rests on two interconnected claims, each of which finds a direct parallel in the cryptoeconomy.

First, that sustained technological progress depends on the interaction between two distinct forms of knowledge: propositional and prescriptive knowledge. Mokyr (2002) distinguished between propositional knowledge — knowledge about natural phenomena, the underlying principles of why things work — and prescriptive knowledge — practical knowledge about techniques, the how of making and doing things (see also Mokyr (2005)). His key insight is that progress stalls when these two forms of knowledge are disconnected, such as if practitioners improve techniques through blind trial and error without understanding why they work, and theorists develop principles that never find practical application. Sustained growth requires the feedback loop of propositional knowledge becoming widely accessible, so practitioners can improve techniques systematically, and that successful techniques in turn generate new theoretical questions. Mokyr's framing has generated a growing body of empirical work testing and extending the feedback loop hypothesis across different historical contexts (Koschnick, 2025). As we elaborate in section 3, cryptography, mechanism design, and game theory constitute the propositional base, while the practical know-how of governance design, incentive structuring, and credibility without central authority is the prescriptive knowledge deployed as institutional infrastructure.

The second and more fundamental claim, developed in his book *A Culture of Growth* (2016), is that this feedback loop between knowledge types only operates where a prior cultural configuration makes it possible. Formal institutions may permit innovation without guaranteeing it – markets and property rights create conditions for exchange without creating the *disposition* to experiment. What distinguishes societies that experienced sustained progress is whether their cultural norms legitimated novelty, protected heterodox inquiry from suppression by vested interests, and sustained collective belief in the possibility of improvement. As Mokyr argues:

> The emergence of such beliefs among some individuals is never sufficient to generate economic growth; they must emerge in the right environment – one that is somehow conducive to rapid changes in attitudes and beliefs, which ultimately affect every aspect of society. (Mokyr, 2016)

Growth cultures are historically rare because the default condition is suppression. Incumbent interests resist innovations that threaten existing arrangements, and without cultural norms actively protecting experimentation, progress remains episodic rather than cumulative. It is these two components together — the cultural preconditions for sustained improvement, and the knowledge infrastructure through which that improvement compounds — that the rest of this chapter traces in the cryptoeconomy.

3 Crypto's Republic of Forum Posts

Crypto's overlapping knowledge communities function as a modern Republic of Letters. The modern cryptoeconomy, just like Europe centuries ago, is decentralised, open, and oriented toward the continuous production and circulation of useful knowledge. Some of those communities organise around particular blockchain ecosystems (e.g. Ethereum), others around specific applications (e.g. Chainlink), and others still around shared technical problems that cut across both. What they share is a commitment to coordinating in public: governance proposals are openly debated before votes are cast, security vulnerabilities are disclosed across ecosystems, and post-mortems of exploits are written up and circulated as reference material for anyone designing their own safeguards.[4] This is not merely a cultural preference but a structural feature of how the cryptoeconomy produces and accumulates knowledge.

Mokyr described the Republic of Letters as an institutional mechanism through which useful knowledge was coordinated and circulated across Europe. It was a transnational network through which natural philosophers could share observations, debate theories, and publicise practical applications. While it had a small physical presence — such as academics being housed at universities, and the printing presses of Amsterdam — the Republic of letters was:

> … above all a *virtual* community: it had at first no formal institutions, no annual congress, it did not publish its own periodical, and yet it managed to create and enforce a substantial number of rules that supported the emergence of open science in Europe. (Mokyr, 2016, p. 187)

The cryptoeconomy similarly coordinates through a global virtual system of governance forums, Telegram group chats and online networks. This mode of production — distributed, open, and organised around shared knowledge rather than proprietary control — is what Benkler (2006) identified as commons-based peer production, a structural alternative to both market and firm-based knowledge creation. Allen and Potts (2016) and Potts (2019) have similarly shown that innovation commons — shared institutional spaces in which participants pool knowledge and coordinate around new rules — are a distinctive and underappreciated

[4] For example see rekt.news

mode of economic organisation, one that the cryptoeconomy instantiates at unprecedented scale.

Crypto's knowledge networks serve a similar function albeit at a greater scale. A governance mechanism proven in one DAO can be adopted and adapted by another within weeks. A design to address voter apathy, for instance, becomes available for immediate inspection, modification, and redeployment across other governance communities. A security vulnerability patched in one protocol is publicly disclosed, and the patch itself becomes a reusable solution for another protocol facing the same class of problem. Open source code is not just visible, it is implementable.

What circulates through these open networks is both propositional and prescriptive knowledge, and it is their interaction that drives cumulative improvement. The underlying principles of cryptography, mechanism design, and game theory provide the theoretical foundations that allow practitioners to improve techniques systematically. The practical know-how about how to design incentive mechanisms that align individual and collective interests, for instance, is the prescriptive knowledge that gets deployed as institutional infrastructure.

Crypto has its own version of what Mokyr called the Industrial Enlightenment, or the deliberate bridging between savants and fabricants that he traces in *The Enlightened Economy* (2011) as the mechanism through which Enlightenment science was translated into industrial technique. Various proposals (e.g. Ethereum Improvement Proposals) function as the formal literature of this applied knowledge community, translating advances in academic cryptography and mechanism design into deployable protocol specifications.

Decentralisation also means that search and experimentation were carried out by many independent units (Mokyr, 1992). While this overlap was in some ways wasteful (because knowledge might be produced multiple times independently) it had the benefit of minimising the chances that any significant opportunity would go unexplored.

A decentralised system also increases the costs that any single authority could suppress inconvenient findings or monopolise access to useful techniques. Crypto's permissionless architecture makes centralised suppression of circulating knowledge structurally difficult for the same reason that political censorship could not contain the Republic of Letters: the network operates across too many jurisdictions and nodes for any single actor to control.

A distinctive feature of crypto's knowledge production is that builders and users are often the same people. Unlike most technological ecosystems where these populations are largely separate, crypto communities routinely contain both the developers who design technical mechanisms and the participants who use them and report back loudly and publicly on what works under real conditions. They are, as Eric von Hippel would describe them, *user innovators* (Allen & Potts, 2023; Von Hippel, 2005). This presense of user innovators

collapses the distance between the propositional and practical knowledge that Mokyr distinguishes between. A user who loses funds to a poorly designed liquidation mechanism contributes directly to the community's stock of prescriptive knowledge about what institutional arrangements work. Crypto communities are practically oriented in a way that disciplines this accumulation — protocols must attract and retain users and capital to survive, and the cryptoeconomy produces unusually legible feedback through metrics such as total value locked, governance participation rates, and token prices.

The incentive structure that sustains this openness mirrors what Mokyr identified in the Republic of Letters. As he observed you can have a culture and other institutions that create a viable market for ideas:

> In practical terms the Republic of Letters was both an institution supporting the operation of a marketplace and an identity. The market was one in which persuasion was akin to a successful sale, and the payoff was enhanced reputation. It provided an unusual institutional framework that eventually proved of crucial importance to the economic development of Europe by setting up norms and incentives that made the market for ideas work. (Mokyr, 2016, p. 186)

The cryptoeconomy has some parallel mechanisms, with status accrued through visible commit histories, proposal authorship, on-chain governance participation, and demonstrated expertise in public forums. As Rennie and Potts (2024) observe, this reputation takes distinctively new forms in blockchain communities where contribution records are permanent, pseudonymous, and publicly verifiable — a wallet address or GitHub handle can accumulate decades of auditable credibility.

The structural reasons for crypto's openness reinforce one another. Crypto communities are pseudonymous and global, lacking any shared physical space or central coordinating authority, which means public communication is the only available medium through which distributed contributors who may never meet can coordinate at all. As Eghbal (2020) argues, working in public transforms the dynamics of knowledge production — it makes contribution visible, reputation portable, and learning cumulative in ways that closed development cannot achieve. The underlying economics of this behaviour are well established. Developers in open source communities contribute openly when the reputational returns to visible contribution outweigh the costs of disclosure (Lerner & Tirole, 2002). The composability of digital infrastructure — where digital infrastructure is modular and stackable so that it can be integrated and recombined (Berg, 2024) — intensifies the potential benefits. A developer who cannot examine how an underlying system functions cannot safely build on top of it, which means open knowledge is an epistemic precondition for composable building rather than merely a cultural preference.

What distinguishes crypto's knowledge communities from their Enlightenment predecessors is adversarial real-time testing at scale. Ideas in the Republic of Letters could circulate untested for years. Crypto's knowledge networks operate on infrastructure that tests institutional claims immediately and in public. Deployed protocols are attacked by profit-motivated adversaries the moment they go live, governance mechanisms face real attempts at capture, and every outcome is recorded on-chain and preserved in perpetuity. The "don't trust, verify" culture that pervades the cryptoeconomy is not mere scepticism but an epistemological commitment to adversarial testing as the basis of reliable knowledge.

4 Crypto cultural entrepreneurs

Cultural change does not propagate itself. Knowledge communities can exist, useful ideas can circulate, and the theoretical conditions for growth can be present, and yet a culture can still fail to tip toward sustained improvement. Mokyr's answer to this problem is what he calls the cultural entrepreneur. A cultural entrepreneur models new behaviours, demonstrates that heterodox commitments are possible, and convinces others to follow those ideas. As Mokyr (2016, p. 62) answers the question of precisely what it is a cultural entrepreneur does:

> They are persons who become sufficiently influential to change the cultural menus of enough people and who persuade many of them to adopt the cultural variants they are proposing.

Without cultural entrepreneurs acting first, absorbing the uncertainty and reputational risk of unvalidated beliefs, cultures of growth could remain latent. Mokyr's exemplar cultural entrepreneurs are Francis Bacon and Isaac Newton, each of whom receives their own chapter in *A Culture of Growth*. Bacon mattered less for the specific content of his writings than for the project he envisioned: putting science to work for material progress and demonstrating that the natural world could be systematically interrogated for human benefit. Newton then delivered that programme at the highest level, making cumulative improvement of knowledge seem not merely possible but inevitable. Mokyr stresses that he is not arguing for individual brilliance, but because of the way cultural entrepreneurs get ideas to spread, get adopted, and reshape what the broader community treats as normal and worth pursuing. Indeed, as Mokyr (2016, p. 66) argues, cultural entrepreneurs matter because they

> Change what people believe, and if enough important people are converted, they will change institutions to conform with the new beliefs and thus the environment in which the next generation of cultural entrepreneurs find themselves.

Satoshi Nakamoto is crypto's founding cultural entrepreneur. The Bitcoin whitepaper was published pseudonymously, without institutional backing, to a mailing list of cryptographers operating at the margins of legitimate technical culture. It was an idea and a willingness to release it into the world under conditions of complete uncertainty. That act established the

template for crypto's concentrated growth culture more powerfully than any manifesto could have – build something real, make it open, release it without permission, and let it be judged by whether it works. Satoshi's pseudonymity compounded the cultural significance, demonstrating that the work itself was what mattered rather than the institutional credentials of its author. Figures like Vitalik Buterin and the founders of other blockchains and communities extended the template into new domains, each extension propelling the founding norm and widening the cultural permission to build.

Cultural entrepreneurship in the cryptoeconomy did not remain the contained to founders. DeFi summer in 2020 was not the product of a single visionary but a distributed wave of builders — teams behind Compound, Uniswap, Yearn, Aave, and others — who collectively demonstrated that decentralised financial primitives could work at scale and generate genuine institutional alternatives to traditional finance (Mohan, 2022). The NFT explosion pushed the same logic into decentralised property rights and creator economies. The DAO experiments carried it into governance, with communities building and stress-testing novel coordination mechanisms in public, absorbing failures visibly, and iterating forward. Each wave was a decentralised and distributed process of people acting under uncertainty, building in the open, and letting the work be judged. Together they established that institutional experimentation was not a founding-generation phenomenon but a continuously renewable feature of the culture.

For norms to spread beyond those who witnessed these founding acts, they need to be compressed into portable symbols that can travel cheaply across a distributed global community. One way that culture spreads in crypto is through *memes*. Memes look like trivial internet culture rather than serious institutional dynamics. But memes are powerful cultural technologies for compressing and transmitting normative commitments. That is, precisely the kind of mechanisms that Mokyr identifies as necessary for cultural diffusion across dispersed networks. Enlightenment natural philosophers reproduced their belief in progress through correspondence networks, learned societies, and shared commitments to open debate. Crypto memes perform an analogous function at global scale and at speed those networks could never have achieved.

BUIDL — a misspelling of 'build' — encodes the fundamental commitment to construction over speculation, signalling that value comes from creating systems rather than merely trading tokens. Crucially, projects and individuals are evaluated within crypto communities partly on whether they are genuinely building or merely extracting value. The meme creates reputational pressure toward productive contribution, not just aspirational rhetoric. WAGMI (We're All Gonna Make It) sustains collective optimism across downturns that would otherwise trigger abandonment, reinforcing the belief that setbacks are temporary and the project of building better coordination systems will ultimately succeed. GM (Good Morning) appears to be merely a greeting, but its daily rhythms of exchange in Telegram chats and

Discord channels create the social cohesion necessary for sustained collaboration across distributed networks lacking any physical proximity. These are not decorative features of crypto culture but deep cultural transmission mechanisms.

What is notable is not that crypto produces memes, but that those memes consistently encode growth-oriented commitments. They reinforce the conviction that better coordination systems can be engineered, that institutional problems are solvable through design, and that the work of building is both individually rational and collectively valuable. That cultural architecture does not merely accompany the growth dynamics examined in the sections above – it *is* the medium through which those dynamics are sustained, transmitted, and made available to each new generation of builders entering the ecosystem.

5 Embedded incentives and growth dynamics

Every growth culture requires incentive systems that make all of that effort individually rational. Indeed, Mokyr (2016, p. 183) asks:

> The question that it [open science] resolved was the classic dilemma of an inappropriable but valuable resource: if knowledge was regarded a public good and dispensed freely, as open science demanded, how would those who created it be incentivized and rewarded? What kind of property rights could intellectual innovators secure?

Mokyr was careful to show that Enlightenment natural philosophers were not purely disinterested pursuers of truth. They operated within competitive "markets for ideas" where reputation, patronage, and priority of discovery created powerful personal incentives to produce and circulate useful knowledge. The Republic of Letters was not just a community of shared values but a structured arena in which disclosure was individually rewarding and secrecy was costly. Those incentive systems were, however, external to the knowledge itself. Reputation had to be built through social recognition, patronage depended on the preferences of wealthy sponsors and priority claims required institutional memory and community consensus to enforce.

Crypto enabled new incentive mechanisms to be developed by embedding incentives through new digital property rights. A developer who builds a protocol that attracts users does not merely gain reputation, they also gain a direct financial stake in the system they created. A community that successfully governs a shared treasury is not rewarded only with social capital but with the appreciated value of the assets under that governance. Tokens transform participation in institutional experimentation from an activity whose rewards are largely indirect and socially mediated into one whose returns are programmable, transparent, and immediate. Where Mokyr's natural philosophers depended on patrons and peers to validate

and reward their contributions, crypto builders can encode that validation directly into the systems they construct.

This compression of incentives into the infrastructure of experimentation impacts the pace and density of institutional innovation. Proposals that in traditional contexts would require years of lobbying and coalition-building can be coded, deployed, and capitalised within weeks. Communities can signal support for promising institutional experiments by acquiring and using the tokens that represent participation in them, directing capital toward innovation without requiring permission from centralised gatekeepers. The result is not merely faster experimentation but a qualitatively different relationship between builders and the institutions they create. A normative commitment to building is reinforced by a property rights structure that makes building directly and transparently rewarding.

6 Conclusion

We have argued in this chapter that what makes the cryptoeconomy historically remarkable is its character as the most concentrated culture of institutional improvement since the Enlightenment. This is not hyperbole. It is an analytical claim grounded in Mokyr's framework. Where Enlightenment Europe developed cultural norms that enabled cumulative technological progress, crypto communities have developed cultural norms that enable cumulative institutional progress. The difference is that where Enlightenment natural philosophers demonstrated that the material world could be systematically understood and improved, crypto communities are demonstrating that institutional arrangements — money, property rights, contracts — are also open to deliberate redesign.

While the cryptoeconomy can seem chaotic with its proliferation of competing protocols, rapid experimentation, and contentious governance debates, this may reflect the dynamics of a growth cultures rather than dysfunction. The cryptoeconomy growth culture is uniquely concentrated because of many reinforcing mechanisms. There are cultural norms that legitimate experimentation, open knowledge communities that accelerate diffusion, cultural entrepreneurs who model the norm of building under uncertainty, and a property rights architecture that embeds incentives for contribution directly into the infrastructure of experimentation itself.

But as Mokyr taught us, growth cultures are fragile. The cultural conditions enabling sustained improvement are neither natural nor self-maintaining. The Enlightenment's culture of growth was historically contingent, and it faced persistent pressure from conservative authorities, incumbent interests, and the natural tendency of successful institutions to ossify into vested interests resistant to further change. Crypto now confronts directly comparable pressures. Regulatory frameworks developed to serve incumbent financial intermediaries embed assumptions incompatible with decentralised coordination, and the risk is not outright prohibition but the more insidious possibility that compliance gradually transforms crypto

protocols into variants of the traditional institutions they were built to replace. As communities grow and protocols mature, early participants accumulate vested interests in stability rather than experimentation, institutional investors demand familiar governance structures, and the distinctive cultural characteristics that made the ecosystem generative risk diluting into conventional corporate forms. The cryptoeconomy's permissionless forking, composability and radical transparency provide some structural protection against these pressures that earlier technological movements lacked. But technical affordances alone do not preserve a growth culture. What matters is whether it maintains commitments to experimentation against the sustained pull of normalisation.

If crypto is indeed the most concentrated growth culture since the Enlightenment, its long-run significance depends on whether that culture endures. Mokyr spent his career demonstrating that growth cultures are historically rare configurations, difficult to assemble and easy to lose. The challenge for crypto is not whether it produces valuable technology, but whether it maintains the cultural conditions that make sustained institutional progress possible whilst integrating into broader economic and political systems that were not designed with those conditions in mind.

References

Acemoglu, D., & Robinson, J. A. (2013). *Why nations fail: The origins of power, prosperity, and poverty* (Paperback ed). Profile Books.

Allen, D. W. E. (2019). Entrepreneurial Exit: Developing the Cryptoeconomy. In M. Swan, J. Potts, S. Takagi, F. Witte, & P. Tasca, *Blockchain Economics: Implications of Distributed Ledgers* (Vol. 01, pp. 197–214). WORLD SCIENTIFIC (EUROPE). https://doi.org/10.1142/9781786346391_0010

Allen, D. W. E., & Potts, J. (2016). How innovation commons contribute to discovering and developing new technologies. *International Journal of the Commons*, *10*(2), 1035. https://doi.org/10.18352/ijc.644

Allen, D. W. E., & Potts, J. (2023). Web3 toolkits: A user innovation theory of crypto development. *Journal of Open Innovation: Technology, Market, and Complexity*, *9*(2), 100050.

Benkler, Y. (Ed.). (2006). *The wealth of networks: How social production transforms markets and freedom*. Yale University Press.

Berg, A., & Berg, C. (2017). Exit, voice, and forking. *Cosmos + Taxis*, *8*(8), 9.

Berg, C., Davidson, S., & Potts, J. (2019). *Understanding the blockchain economy: An introduction to institutional cryptoeconomics*. Edward Elgar Publishing.

Brunton, F. (2019). *Digital cash: The unknown history of the anarchists, utopians, and technologists who built cryptocurrency*. Princeton University Press.

De Filippi, P., & Loveluck, B. (2016). The invisible politics of Bitcoin: Governance crisis of a decentralised infrastructure. *Internet Policy Review*, *5*(3). https://doi.org/10.14763/2016.3.427

Eghbal, N. (2020). *Working in public: The making and maintenance of open source software* (First edition). Stripe Press.

Hirschman, A. O. (1970). *Exit, Voice, and Loyalty: Responses to Decline in Firms, Organizations, and States*. Harvard University Press.

Koschnick, J. (2025). Did a feedback mechanism between propositional and prescriptive knowledge create modern growth? *arXiv Preprint arXiv:2512.16587*.

Lerner, J., & Tirole, J. (2002). Some Simple Economics of Open Source. *The Journal of Industrial Economics*, *50*(2), 197–234. https://doi.org/10.1111/1467-6451.00174

MacDonald, T. J. (2019). *Political economy of non-territorial exit: Cryptosecession*. Edward Elgar Publishing.

McCloskey, D. N. (2011). *Bourgeois dignity: Why economics can't explain the modern world*. University of Chicago Press.

Mohan, V. (2022). Automated market makers and decentralized exchanges: A DeFi primer. *Financial Innovation*, *8*(1), 20. https://doi.org/10.1186/s40854-021-00314-5

Mokyr, J. (1992). *The lever of riches: Technological creativity and economic progress* (1. issued as an Oxford Univ. Press paperback, [Nachdr.]). Oxford Univ. Press.

Mokyr, J. (2002). *The Gifts of Athena: Historical Origins of the Knowledge Economy*. Princeton University Press.

Mokyr, J. (2005). The intellectual origins of modern economic growth. *The Journal of Economic History*, *65*(2), 285–351.

Mokyr, J. (2011). *The enlightened economy: Britain and the industrial revolution, 1700-1850*. Penguin UK.

Mokyr, J. (2016). *A culture of growth: The origins of the modern economy*. Princeton University Press.

Nabben, K. (2023a). Cryptoeconomics as governance: An intellectual history from "Crypto Anarchy" to "Cryptoeconomics." *Internet Histories*, *7*(3), 254–276.

Nabben, K. (2023b). Web3 as 'self-infrastructuring': The challenge is how. *Big Data & Society*, *10*(1), 20539517231159002. https://doi.org/10.1177/20539517231159002

Nabben, K., & Zargham, M. (2022). Permissionlessness. *Internet Policy Review*, *11*(2). https://doi.org/10.14763/2022.2.1656

North, D. C. (1990). *Institutions, institutional change and economic performance*. Cambridge University Press.

Potts, J. (2019). *Innovation Commons: The Origin of Economic Growth*. Oxford University Press USA - OSO.

Rennie, E., & Potts, J. (2024). Contribution systems: A new theory of value. *Available at SSRN 4754267*.

Von Hippel, E. (2005). Democratizing innovation: The evolving phenomenon of user innovation. *Journal Für Betriebswirtschaft*, *55*(1), 63–78.